Tarek Tawila

Full-Stack Developer · React · TypeScript · Node.js · Next.js

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PROFILE

Full-stack developer who builds production web apps end to end: database, API, interface, deployment and monitoring. In 2026 I shipped two live platforms as the sole engineer: a bilingual e-commerce store with online payments and delivery dispatch in Kuwait, and a registration and judging platform for a national youth competition in Saudi Arabia. I specialise in Arabic/English right-to-left interfaces, accessible UI (WCAG AA), and the parts of a product that must hold up under real use: payments, concurrency and reliable notifications. A background in 3D animation and two years of QA at Electronic Arts give me an eye for detail in both design and quality.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend	React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, Vite, React Router
Backend	Node.js, Express, Next.js server actions, REST APIs, webhooks, NextAuth, Python, Flask
Data	PostgreSQL, Prisma, SQLite, SQLAlchemy, Elasticsearch, transactions and locking
DevOps	Docker / Docker Compose, Nginx, Linux (Ubuntu), Bash, GitHub Actions CI, Cloudflare, Railway, Sentry
Testing	Vitest, Playwright, node:test, end-to-end and smoke suites, regression tests for every fix
i18n & accessibility	Arabic/English with RTL layout (next-intl, LinguiJS), WCAG AA, keyboard and screen-reader support, Core Web Vitals
Integrations	uPayments (KNET, Apple Pay, cards), Armada delivery API, WhatsApp APIs, Cloudflare R2 / S3, Resend, Spotify Web API

EXPERIENCE

Freelance Full-Stack Developer · **Self-employed** · Remote — Jun 2026 – Present

Al Bahar Perfumes e-commerce platform (albaharperfumes.com), Kuwait — Jun 2026 – Present

- Designed, built and run the production store for a Kuwaiti luxury perfume retailer: bilingual Arabic/English (RTL/LTR) storefront in React, TypeScript, Vite and Tailwind, with a Node.js/Express API.
- Integrated online payments through uPayments (KNET, Visa/Mastercard, Apple Pay, Google Pay) with HMAC-signed API requests.
- Automated delivery: live fee estimates and dispatch to 3 store branches through the Armada API, webhook status tracking, and a WhatsApp alert for every paid order with retries and a fallback provider.
- Built an admin dashboard (products, orders, coupons, reviews, blog) and a B2B wholesale module with Net 30/60 payment terms.
- Added Elasticsearch product search in both languages, with a built-in fallback search if Elasticsearch is unavailable.
- Deployed with Docker, Nginx and Cloudflare on a Linux VPS, with Sentry monitoring, 6-hourly offsite database backups and GitHub Actions CI running ~400 automated tests.
- Met WCAG AA accessibility and removed layout shift on the product grid (CLS 0.57 to ~0).

National Ambassadors registration & judging platform (ksaambassadors.com), Saudi Arabia — Sep 2026 – Present

- Sole engineer: architecture, database, design system, application, infrastructure, deployment and post-launch QA. Built with Next.js, TypeScript, Prisma, PostgreSQL, Railway and Cloudflare R2.
- Built team registration for groups of 3–5 students (invites, OTP verification, document uploads) and a staff console for verifying documents, scoring, assigning judges and publishing decisions.
- Delivered full Arabic/English support with RTL layout, Arabic typography and correct Arabic plural rules; about 90% of the first cohort used Arabic.
- Prevented race conditions (last open seat, OTP guessing bursts, simultaneous decision publishing) with PostgreSQL row and advisory locks, each covered by a deterministic race test.
- Raised landing-page throughput about 6x by serving it statically; 500+ automated tests (Vitest, Playwright) in CI.

Software Engineer (Internship) · **OpenQQuantify** · Remote May 2025 – Oct 2025

- Modernized React and Bootstrap frontend components to improve UI consistency across the product.
- Built and debugged Flask/SQLAlchemy REST API endpoints, including authentication and data-handling features.
- Took part in code reviews, debugging and feature work across the stack in Agile sprints.

Frontend Developer, Independent Projects · Remote Jun 2024 – May 2025

- Jamming: React playlist app on the Spotify Web API with OAuth, search and saving playlists to the user's account.
- PaperLight: multilingual Flask app with authentication, PostgreSQL/SQLAlchemy models and secure form handling.
- Coffee Chronicles: full-stack Flask app combining dataset analysis, an AI chat assistant and music streaming.

Game Tester (Quality Assurance) · **Electronic Arts** · Bucharest 2019 – 2021

- Tested global multiplayer titles (Apex Legends, Battlefield Mobile); reproduced, isolated and documented bugs and performance regressions in Jira and TestRail.

Freelance Video Editor & Visual Designer 2016 – 2024

- Video, motion graphics and visual design with Adobe Premiere Pro, After Effects and Photoshop.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

JavaScript Test Automation Program · EPAM Systems 2026

Front-End Development Practicum · Mayerfeld Consulting (certificate) 2025

BFA, Animation, Interactive Technology, Video Graphics & Special Effects · SAE Institute, Jordan 2016 – 2019

Diploma, 3D Animation & Game Design · SAE Institute Bucharest 2018 – 2019

LANGUAGES

English (fluent) · Arabic (native) · Romanian (basic, A2)